



GINA FERRAZZI Los Angeles Times

UNION members rally downtown on Wednesday. More than 60,000 essential workers would join the strike.

MASSIVE STRIKE LOOMS FOR LAUSD

Workers and teachers announce they'll walk off job April 14 if no contract is reached.

By Howard Blume

Los Angeles Unified's two largest labor groups — the teachers union and service employees — announced Wednesday they will join forces and both go on strike April 14 if no contract deal is reached before then, actions that would in effect shut down schools in less than a month.

The strike would affect close to 400,000 students in the nation's second-largest school system and an estimated 32,000 students in the adult school. It would mean more than 60,000 essential district workers — teachers, counselors, nurses, bus drivers, janitors and cafeteria workers — would walk off the job, crippling school operations.

The strike would come at a particularly difficult time for the Los Angeles Unified School District, with Supt. Alberto Carvalho on paid administrative leave following an FBI raid on his San Pedro home and downtown L.A. office and hundreds of layoffs anticipated amid what he previously described as a troubled budget at its “breaking point.”

United Teachers Los Angeles President Cecily Myart-Cruz and Max Arias, the executive director of Service Employees Interna-

[See Strike, A6]

AI to help county judges craft rulings

Pilot program will assist with backlogs. Some officials fear external influence.

By James Queally

Judges in one of the nation's largest court systems have started using artificial intelligence, testing a tool that can rapidly distill hundreds of pages of legal motions and use samples of a jurist's writing style to help reach conclusions and even draft tentative rulings.

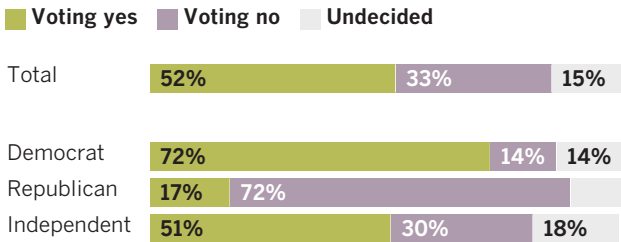
The program, which launched last month, gave half a dozen Los Angeles County civil court judges access to AI software called Learned Hand. Although it could prove crucial in a

A slim majority supports billionaire tax, poll finds

Californians are sharply divided over proposal as well as voter ID

By Nicole Nixon

Democrats more likely to support billionaire tax than Republicans



Berkeley Institute of Governmental Studies poll conducted online in English and Spanish March 9-14 among 5,019 registered voters in California. There is an estimated margin of error of +/-2.5 points. Funding for the poll was provided in part by the Los Angeles Times.

HAILEY WANG Los Angeles Times

In UC Jewish community, perceptions of bias differ

By Jaweed Kaleem

Jewish faculty, students and others are calling on UC leaders to improve how they handle complaints of anti-semitism — saying university response has been inadequate — but their viewpoints paint widely differing pictures of the campus climate for Jews.

One letter originated from a national group that works to combat anti-semitism at colleges and cited its own research to conclude that Jewish UC students have faced “unprecedented harassment, intimidation, and exclusion” since

the Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas attack on Israel and Israel's ensuing war in Gaza spurred widespread anti-Israel campus protests.

Separately on Monday, at least 117 Jewish UCLA faculty members released a letter saying they are “absolutely united in our vehement opposition” to a recent Trump administration lawsuit accusing the university of allowing pervasive anti-semitism on campus and called on the government to drop the litigation. The faculty members expressed fear that the Trump administration wants UC to “falsely” take on antisemitism by imposing “more draconian

SACRAMENTO — A new poll shows California voters are sharply divided over two brewing statewide ballot measures stirring up the nation's partisan and economic divides: a one-time tax on billionaires to pay for mostly healthcare and a voter ID mandate that includes citizenship verification.

The survey conducted by UC Berkeley's Institute of Governmental Studies and co-sponsored by The Times showed 52% of registered voters supported the billionaire tax, while 33% said they opposed it. Fifteen percent were undecided.

Support for the voter ID measure was more evenly split, with 44% of voters in support, 45% opposed and the remainder undecided.

The pair of statewide pro-

[See Poll, A11]

Chavez accused of abusing girls, raping Huerta

Alleged incidents occurred in 1960s and 1970s, according to newspaper inquiry.

By Karen Garcia, Richard Winton, Melissa Gomez and Ruben Vives



Bettmann Archive

THE ALLEGATIONS have spurred a wider reckoning of the California labor leader.

Accusations puncture myth

The reckoning now over Cesar Chavez is only right, Gustavo Arellano writes. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Heartbreaking burden of an icon

Huerta shows another kind of heroism with her story, Anita Chabria writes. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

who report sexual abuse,” the statement said. “This is deeply painful to our family.”

Huerta said she experienced two sexual encounters with Chavez. The first time, she was “manipulated and pressured into having sex with him,” she said, and felt she couldn't say anything because he was her boss and the leader of a movement to which she was devoted.

“The second time I was forced, against my will, and in an environment where I felt trapped,” her statement said. “I had experienced abuse and sexual violence before, and I convinced myself these were incidents

[See Inquiry, A7]



Cathy Murphy Getty Images

DOLORES HUERTA, shown at a rally in the mid-1970s, co-founded the UFW with Cesar Chavez.

Huerta ‘carried secret’ for a cause

Activist says she didn't want to derail the union effort. ‘My heart aches for everyone who suffered.’

By Hannah Fry

In the pages of history, they were a team that changed the world.

Cesar Chavez and Dolores Huerta founded the United Farm Workers and brought new life to the American labor movement, drawing national attention to the brutal working conditions and unlivable wages that agricultural workers experienced.

Chavez was the revered leader. But Huerta is also a legend, a fiercely independent mother with a passion for addressing the social issues of the time — women's rights, poverty and racism. When Chavez died in 1993, she took on the mantle that, at age 95, she still wears.

But for six decades, Huerta said on Wednesday, she was keeping a secret.

In an emotional statement, Huerta said that Chavez had raped her in the 1960s, something she had kept under wraps until allegations surfaced in the New York Times that the labor

leader had sexually abused two underage girls in the 1970s.

Huerta said she felt “manipulated and pressured” to have sex with Chavez the first time. The second time, he forced her to have sex against her will “in an environment where I felt trapped,” she said. Both encounters led to pregnancies, which she hid at the time. She arranged for the children to be raised by other families “that could give them stable lives.”

Huerta addressed her long silence on the matter, suggesting she tried to put the movement and those who could benefit from it first.

“I carried this secret for as long as I did because building the movement and securing farmworker rights was my life's work,” she said. “The formation of a union was the only vehicle to accomplish and secure those rights and I wasn't going to let Cesar or anyone else get in the way.”

The New York Times [See Huerta, A7]

Senators question nominee Mullin

Trump's pick for Homeland Security secretary says he'll tackle immigration policy concerns. **NATION, A4**

Venezuela's WBC win earns respect

The U.S. couldn't get the hits it needed in a tournament widely deemed a global success, writes Bill Shaikin. **SPORTS, B10**

D'Amaro takes reins at Disney

New chief executive begins his tenure as Bob Iger steps into a senior advisory role ahead of retirement. **BUSINESS, A9**

Weather
Very hot.
L.A. Basin: 97/62. **B6**

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.



7 85944 00200 5



Graeme Sloan Bloomberg

TULSI Gabbard, third from left, at a hearing.

Israel kills Iran's spy chief in strike

National intelligence head Tulsi Gabbard tells Congress that Tehran's government is “largely degraded.” **WORLD, A3**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A12**